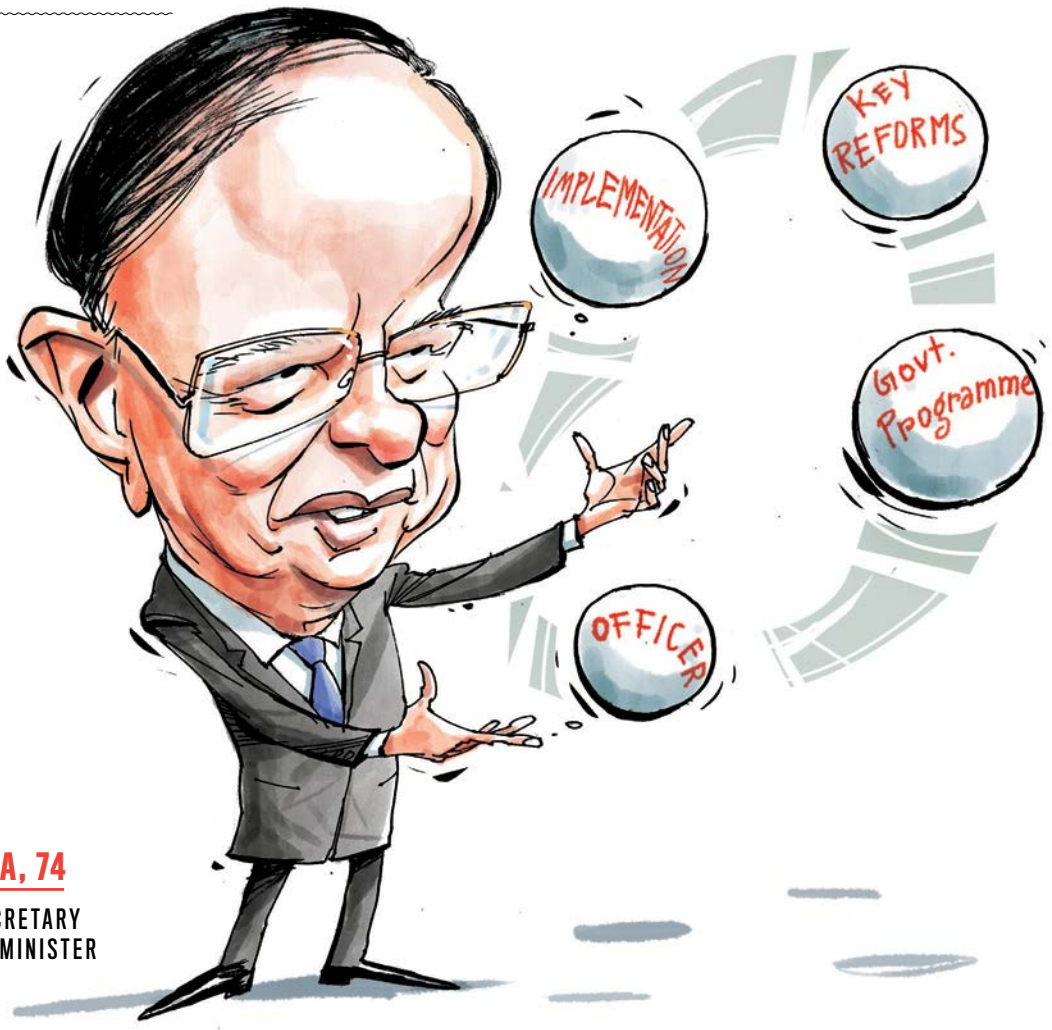


2 → P.K. MISHRA, 74

PRINCIPAL SECRETARY TO THE PRIME MINISTER OF INDIA

THE NATION'S GUARDIAN

BECAUSE Doval has spearheaded India's security and strategic affairs for the past nine years, probably the longest-ever stint for an NSA. His clout can be gauged from the fact that in February he had a rare meeting with Russian president Vladimir Putin, who normally meets only heads of states, sharing with him India's stand on the Ukraine war and its handling of the West

BECAUSE Doval held a series of high-level meetings in Washington, DC, where he led the Indian side to attend the first-ever meeting of the Initiative on Critical and Emerging Technologies (iCET), agreed upon between Modi and US President Joe Biden in 2022

GOD-FEARING MAN The national security czar is a deeply religious person. Recently, he performed 'Bhasmarti' and 'Jal Abhishek' at the famous Mahakaleshwar Temple in Ujjain, MP

3 AJIT DOVAL, 78

NATIONAL SECURITY ADVISOR →

BECAUSE Doval is in talks with his counterparts in the US, UAE and Saudi Arabia to work out a joint rail project that will not only connect Gulf and Arab countries with India via sea ports but also counter China's efforts to expand its footprint in the region through the Belt and Road Initiative

BECAUSE Doval's office is instrumental in deciding the Indian military's approach to counter the aggressive posturing of the People's Liberation Army of China